

home until her children entered school and she started working full-time.

Words of Wisdom

Relationships take work. Disagreements are inevitably going to occur, especially where money is concerned. Money is something that is dealt with every day in addition to the financial decisions that go along with it. Although money decisions may appear to be very cut and dry and unemotional, they are in fact just the opposite. In order to weather the financial storm that many times accompanies financial difficulties, the lessons learned in this chapter are extremely valuable. A couple should:

- Communicate openly and often about money.
- Decide upon mutual goals and develop a plan to reach them.
- Share their financial past and present prior to beginning a life together.
- Avoid hidden stashes.
- Figure out payment arrangements (who pays what).
- Discuss any major purchases or money expenditures prior to acting on them.
- Remember that joint debts are both parties' responsibility.
- Once a divorce is decided upon, do a financial analysis of their post-divorce situation prior to separating.

